PROJECT REPORT

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Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guid

Introduction

For this project, I stepped into the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. My goal wasn't just to check off a list of academic requirements, but to truly understand how to navigate, work, and stay safe in our increasingly digital-first world.

As a first-year student, I've realized that digital literacy is far more than just knowing how to open an app or browse a website. It is a foundational skill set for my future as a Computer Science student specializing in AI and ML. It's about building a credible professional identity, learning to communicate with clarity and respect when dealing with professors and peers, and staying a step ahead of the constant evolution of online threats.

Over the course of five detailed modules, I have documented my personal journey through the following tasks:

- Creating a Canva infographic to break down the complexities of online safety and information navigation.
- Setting up a professional digital portfolio using platforms like Kaggle, Stack Overflow, and ResearchGate to bridge the gap between classroom theory and hands-on practice.
- Exploring coding logic through HackerRank and learning the efficiency of data collection with Google Workspace.
- Drafting professional correspondence and reflecting on the real-world consequences of social media etiquette.
- Analyzing the mechanics of cybercrime through a UPI fraud case study and establishing a personal "hard and fast" rule for financial safety.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Canva makes it easy to create engaging graphical packaging that integrates text, icons and colour, so that it is an easy-to-read, visually stimulating finished product. This infographic provides information about Digital Literacy and its relevance to students. The infographic is organised into three sections: Section 1 is a definition of Digital Literacy; and discusses the importance of being able to navigate through information available via the Internet, communicate digitally, and think critically about the content that is found on the Internet. Section 2 provides suggestions for reputable and effective Digital Tools that students may use to support their academic studies (e.g. digital calendars for time management, digital note-taking apps to keep ideas organised, collaboration tools for group assignment etc). Section 3 provides examples of how students can remain safe while using the Internet including the use of strong passwords, identifying potential phishing emails and safe browsing habits.

While I was designing this infographic, I found it interesting that the small things you do to create the overall design (for example: colour pairings and where you place an icon) significantly affect how easily the viewer understands the information. I found balancing all of my design elements so that the layout wouldn't look crowded to be a challenge. Overall it was a creative and educational experience.

TASK 2: BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

As an CSE student with a focus on AI and ML, I have selected platforms such as Kaggle, Stack Overflow and ResearchGate in my journey of education.

Kaggle is a hands-on site that allows me to practice my skills in data science and machine learning by using datasets, entering competitions and creating notebooks in each of these areas. I intend to participate in competitions on a regular basis in order to develop strong hands-on skills.
Stack Overflow is an online community of developers who ask and answer questions about coding so I will use it to help identify and fix bugs in my code, learn about programming concepts, and eventually assist the community by answering questions.
ResearchGate is an online community for academics who wish to collaborate with other researchers by sharing their research papers and ideas; I will use ResearchGate to explore cutting edge AI/ML research, read their research papers and learn about the latest trends in AI and ML.

These three platforms will allow me to enhance my coding abilities, improve my ability to solve problems, and create connections between my hands-on learning and theory based education over the course of the next four years in my pursuit to develop a strong understanding of AI and ML.

TASK 3: EXPLORE CODING &COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

I used *HackerRank* and *Google Forms* to complete this task.

- **Part A: Coding Practice**

I chose HackerRank for this as it offers simple structured coding challenges that make it easy to practice and improve problem-solving skills. I did beginner Python coding challenge on Hacker Rank, I thought this was a really nice way to start. It allowed me to work through the logic of how to break down problems, rather than just making wild guesses to try and find the solution. Coding seemed to be less overwhelming and easier to approach.

- **Part B: Google Workspace Collaboration**

I created a Google Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms and I looked at everyone's answers in Google Sheets. I found it fascinating how quick and easy it is to create the questions and collect answers from everyone in a way that you can visually see them organised.

By working with these tools I found them to be helpful and practical. They not only taught me things that I didn't already know but also showed how these acquired skills could be useful and beneficial in real life, in study and in everyday digital use.

TASK 4: DRAFT A PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ETIQUETTE GUIDE

- **Part A: Write two professional emails**
  I wrote 2 emails on the given topics: extension of assignment deadline and applying for internship.

- **Part B: Create a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist**
  I created a checklist which gives very essential tips for responsible social media usage as a college student.

There was a situation with my very close friend where poor digital communication caused a real problem. He tweeted sarcastically about a "horrible group project," without mentioning anyone specifically. However, members of his team saw the tweet & assumed it was aimed at them, which hurt their feelings. Communication between the group members had broken down as nobody wanted to work together anymore; therefore, the project was negatively impacted. This situation could've been resolved differently if he had directly spoken to their teammates about their concerns respectfully. Avoiding public & general communication and utilizing direct and private communication could have helped them prevent any misunderstandings.

This situation exemplifies how you should think before posting, as any form of comment could come across differently than intended, and lead to additional conflict.

TASK 5: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY & PREVENTION GUIDE

- **Part A: Case Study**
  I chose the topic UPI/Online Payment Fraud and wrote a case study on it in which I took a fictional character Rohan, a student, to better explain the situation.

- **Part B: Prevention Checklist**
  I made a 'Stay Safe Online' checklist with 9 crucial tips crucial to ensure online safety of everyone. It is very relevant for college students in India

  While researching on this topic, I came across many things, but there is nothing more terrifying than when a scammer takes advantage of a student's "urgency" to acquire money. In a matter of seconds, they can go from making a quick sale to losing the entire amount of money from the sale. I think it was the fact that simply sending vs. receiving money can completely wipe out someone's bank account that shocked me the most.

  One habit I will adopt is a "hard and fast" rule, i.e, to never give out my PIN when being sent money. From now on, I will consider any and all unsolicited QR codes as a red flag and will double-check all app permission settings to ensure my security.

Conclusion

Reflecting on this project, I've realized that digital literacy is not just a technical requirement but a fundamental survival skill for the modern world. Exploring tools like **Kaggle** and **HackerRank** showed me how to transition from theory to hands-on problem-solving , while my research into UPI fraud provided a sobering reminder of how easily "urgency" can be exploited. Learning to communicate professionally and protect my data has given me a new sense of responsibility.

Ultimately, this project has transformed the way I view my digital presence—moving from a passive user to a more intentional, secure, and professional digital citizen.